

The Odyssey is a 2026 epic [action fantasy film](#) written and directed by [Christopher Nolan](#), who produced it with his wife [Emma Thomas](#). An adaptation of [Homer's ancient Greek](#) epic poem the *Odyssey*, it stars an [ensemble cast](#) including [Matt Damon](#), [Tom Holland](#), [Anne Hathaway](#), [Robert Pattinson](#), [Lupita Nyong'o](#), [Samantha Morton](#), [Zendaya](#), and [Charlize Theron](#). In the film, [Odysseus](#) (Damon), the Greek king of [Ithaca](#), undergoes a long and perilous journey home after the [Trojan War](#) and encounters mythical beings as he attempts to reunite with his wife [Penelope](#) (Hathaway).

Nolan began writing the script in March 2024 and secured the project with [Universal Pictures](#) by October. *The Odyssey* was announced in December. Casting took place from late 2024 through early 2025, and Damon was confirmed for the lead role in February 2025. Nolan studied several [translations of the Odyssey](#) before deciding upon a maximally [realistic](#) interpretation of [Greek mythology](#), drawing inspiration from the [epic](#) historical films *Andrei Rublev* (1966) and *Ran* (1985), as well as the films of special effects artist [Ray Harryhausen](#). Filming took place [on location](#) from February to August 2025 in [Morocco](#), [Greece](#), [Italy](#), [Scotland](#), [Iceland](#), [Western Sahara](#), and [Malta](#), as well as at the [Universal Studios Lot](#) in Los Angeles. With an estimated budget of \$250 million, it is among the most expensive films of [Nolan's career](#), and the first feature film ever to be shot entirely on [IMAX's 70 mm film](#) cameras.

The Odyssey premiered at the [Odeon Luxe Leicester Square](#) in London on July 6, 2026, ahead of a theatrical release by Universal Pictures on July 17 in the US and the UK. It was made available in IMAX and multiple [premium large formats](#). The film received widespread critical acclaim, with particular praise for Nolan's direction. It has grossed \$640 million worldwide, becoming the [seventh-highest-grossing film of 2026](#), and set numerous records for Nolan, including for some premium format pre-sales that were released a year in advance.

- [Matt Damon](#) as [Odysseus](#), the legendary [Greek](#) king of [Ithaca](#).^[6] Director [Christopher Nolan](#) described Odysseus as complicated, "an amazing strategist, [and] a very wily person".^[7]
- [Tom Holland](#) as [Telemachus](#), Odysseus and Penelope's son and the prince of Ithaca, who is determined to find his father.^{[8][9]}
- [Anne Hathaway](#) as [Penelope](#), wife of Odysseus, mother of Telemachus, and the queen of Ithaca, who fends off [many suitors](#) in her husband's absence.^[10]
- [Robert Pattinson](#) as [Antinous](#), a suitor of Penelope,^[10] whom Pattinson described as sleazy and likened to [James Woods](#)'s character Lester Diamond from the 1995 film *Casino*.^[11]
- [Lupita Nyong'o](#) in a [dual role](#) as:
 - [Helen of Troy](#), wife of Menelaus, described as the most beautiful woman in the world, whose abduction triggers the [Trojan War](#).^[12]
 - [Clytemnestra](#), Helen's [twin sister](#), wife of Agamemnon, who murders him upon his return from Troy.^[12]
- [Samantha Morton](#) as [Circe](#), a witch and goddess on the island of [Aeaea](#).^[12]
- [John Leguizamo](#) as [Eumaeus](#), a blind [swineherd](#), Odysseus's faithful servant.^{[9][13]}

- [Zendaya](#) as [Athena](#), the goddess of wisdom, warfare, and handicraft, who protects Odysseus on his journey.^{[9][12]} Zendaya also portrays the young Trojan priestess of Athena who is killed during the assault on Troy, and whose form Athena later takes.
- [Charlize Theron](#) as [Calypso](#), a [nymph](#) on the island of [Ogygia](#) who tries to entice Odysseus to live as her husband with the promise of immortality.^{[12][14]}
- [Jon Bernthal](#) as [Menelaus](#), the king of [Sparta](#) and Helen's husband.^[9]
- [Himesh Patel](#) as [Eurylochus](#), Odysseus's second-in-command who challenges his thoughts and plans.^{[15][10]}
- [Bill Irwin](#) as the on-set performer of [Polyphemus](#), a Cyclops and son of [Poseidon](#).^{[16][12]}
- [Elliot Page](#) as [Sinon](#), a Greek soldier and the son of a servant of Antinous, who was recruited as a child to be raised to serve as a soldier who would reach adulthood upon the Greeks' arrival at Troy.^[15] Sinon is not in Homer's [original poem](#) and his story was borrowed from [Virgil's Aeneid](#) and other myths.^[17]
- [Benny Safdie](#) as [Agamemnon](#), the Greek king of [Mycenae](#), Clytemnestra's husband, Menelaus's older brother, and the commander of the Greeks during the Trojan War.^{[18][12]}

Other suitors of Penelope include [Corey Hawkins](#) as [Polybus](#),^[15] [Niko Nicotera](#) as [Peisander](#), [Elyes Gabel](#) as [Elatus](#),^[19] [Iddo Goldberg](#) as [Amphimedon](#),^[20] and [Jamie Harris](#) as [Agelus](#). [Mia Goth](#) and [Logan Marshall-Green](#) portray twin siblings [Melantho](#) and [Melanthius](#), who are respectively a disloyal [maidservant](#) of Odysseus and Penelope and Odysseus's dishonest cowherd.^{[7][21][15]} [Ryan Hurst](#) portrays [Mentor](#), Telemachus's guide and teacher,^[22] while [James Remar](#) plays [Tiresias](#), a blind [prophet](#) of the [Greek underworld](#).^[15]

Other members of Odysseus's crew include [Will Yun Lee](#) as [Anchialus](#),^[9] Jimmy Gonzales as [Cepheus](#),^[10] [Andrew Howard](#) as [Polites](#),^[23] [Jovan Adepo](#) as [Elpenor](#), [Jesse Garcia](#) as [Menetus](#), [Josh Stewart](#) as [Antiphates](#),^[24] [Sean Avery](#) as [Laodamas](#),^[25] Anthony Molinari as [Perimedes](#),^[24] Stephen Murphy as [Phemius](#), and Ian Casselberry as [Dolios](#).^[26]

[Travis Scott](#) makes a [cameo appearance](#) as a [bard](#), whom Nolan included because he wanted to allude to how the *Odyssey* had been retold through [oral poetry](#), which he analogized to [rapping](#), Scott's profession.^[12] [Rafi Gavron](#) and [Shiloh Fernandez](#) briefly appear as Trojans who kill Sinon and encounter the Trojan horse.^[27] Others in minor roles include Kate Fuglei as [Eurycleia](#), a loyal servant and nurse of Odysseus and Penelope;^[23] [Maurice Compte](#) as the steward of Menelaus;^[28] [Nick E. Tarabay](#) as the unnamed [helmsman](#) of Telemachus' ship;^[10] [Michael Vlamis](#) as a bandit disguised as a priest who attacks Telemachus in Pylos; and [Brian Vernel](#) as [Irus](#), a beggar in Ithaca.